mouth; the stench of oil and exhaust burned her nose.

Then the Opel was moving. Léa thought it was the force of the half-dozen tanks propelling the car forward, but the driver was shifting gears.

“Stop,” she shouted, trying to be heard above the deafening noise.

“Go back,” Josef yelled. “Stop the car!”

“We don’t have Rose,” André called out.

The car rolled on, the driver’s arm pulling the gearbox back, as he took the tight turns fast.

Léa held on to Katya, panic ripping through her chest. Why had Rose put her arms around Léa and said she loved her? The metallic taste of fear was on her tongue. Rose wasn’t going with them. “Josef, make him stop,” she screamed. “Now. He must stop.” Unhinged, she shook the seat in front of her with one hand. But he was driving too fast, and she had to use both hands to keep Katya from falling.

“He stops . . . I’ll jump out . . . go back,” André shouted.

Léa saw the same fear and panic churning in his eyes that she felt hammering in her chest. Something warned that the driver had no intention of slowing down. And what if Rose wasn’t here because she never intended to come? Maybe she hadn’t forgotten her sketchbooks, but left them behind so that she could leave the car.

Josef must have had the same thought because he turned around, his dark hair knocked sideways by the wind. “We won’t leave her. I promise.”